

3 Interpreting the text and issues of relationship, purpose and authorship	3.1	Interpreting the text a) The synoptic problem, source, form and redaction criticism – an examination of the relationship between the synoptic Gospels, including two source hypothesis (priority of Mark and 'Q source'), the idea of proto-Gospels and the four-source hypothesis. b) Units of tradition and their type/form, the way texts appear to have been translated, edited and transmitted. c) The significance of this for understanding the texts.
	3.2	The purpose and authorship of the Fourth Gospel a) An examination of the different purposes of the Gospel and views of its authorship: Jesus as Christ, Son of God, life in his name, Spiritual Gospel, a Gospel to convert Jews and Gentiles, fulfilment of scripture. b) The strengths and weaknesses of these views based on the text and modern scholarship, and their significance for understanding the text for individuals and communities. With reference to the ideas of R Brown and C H Dodd.